

Meeting Status

Automatic presence sign on e-paper via Bluetooth
User Manual



The tag shows your status in real time – here "IN MEETING".

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This program automatically detects when you are in a meeting or call on your computer, or when you lock your screen, and shows your status – **AVAILABLE**, **IN MEETING** or **AWAY** – both as a colored dot in the Windows system tray and on a small Bluetooth-connected e-paper sign that you can place outside your office or on your monitor.

1. Overview

Meeting Status is a small background program for Windows. It monitors whether any app is using your microphone or camera – which happens as soon as you join a meeting in Teams, Zoom, Meet, Webex, Slack, Discord or similar – and it also reacts the moment you lock your computer with Win+L. Your status is updated accordingly.

The status is shown in two places:

- **In the system tray:** a green dot when you are available, red when you are busy, and blue when you are away.
- **On the e-paper tag:** your name, your status, an optional icon and a colored frame around the whole sign.

Three status modes



Why e-paper? The screen keeps its image with no power at all and only draws battery when it is updated. That is why the tag is **only written when your status actually changes** – not continuously. One update takes 15–20 seconds, which is normal for e-paper.

2. Installation

What you need

- A Windows PC with Bluetooth (most laptops have it built in).
- A Gicisky / PICKSMART 2.9" e-paper tag (black/white/red), which advertises with the name **NEMRxxxxxxx**.
- The program itself (the .exe or the Python script).

If you have the .exe

Just double-click **MeetingStatus.exe**. Nothing else is needed – the settings file, the log and the help file are created automatically next to the program the first time it runs.

If you run the Python script

Install the dependencies and start it:

```
pip install pystray Pillow bleak
python MeetingStatus.py
```

Build the .exe yourself

To turn the script into a standalone executable:

```
pip install pystray Pillow bleak pyinstaller
python -m PyInstaller --onefile --noconsole --name MeetingStatus ^
    --hidden-import=PIL._tkinter_finder ^
    --collect-all pystray --collect-all PIL --collect-all bleak ^
    MeetingStatus.py
```

The result is **dist\MeetingStatus.exe**.

Start automatically at login

Press **Win+R**, type **shell:startup** and press Enter. Place a shortcut to the program in the folder that opens, and it will start every time you log in.

3. First run and settings

The first time you start the program, the settings window opens automatically. You can reach it at any time by right-clicking the icon in the system tray and choosing **Settings...**

Steps to pair the tag

1. Wake the tag by removing and reinserting a battery (it only advertises for a short while after waking).
2. Check **Enable e-paper tag**.
3. Click **Scan for tags** and wait a few seconds.
4. Select your tag in the list (e.g. NEMR92815292) and click **Use selected**.
5. Type your name in the **Name** field – it appears at the top of the tag.
6. Choose optional icons for **AVAILABLE**, **IN MEETING** and **AWAY**.
7. Click **Save**.

The program remembers the tag's address and reconnects automatically next time. If the scan finds no tag, wake it with a battery swap and scan immediately.

New: the settings window now has a third icon dropdown, **When AWAY**, alongside the AVAILABLE and IN MEETING ones. Pick any away icon (for example a padlock) or leave it as (none).

4. Settings in detail

Setting	Description
Name	The name shown at the top of the tag.
Enable e-paper tag	Turns writing to the tag on or off. The tray dot works regardless.
Saved tag	The saved Bluetooth address (e.g. FF:FF:92:81:52:92).
Scan / Use selected / Forget	Scan for tags, select one from the list, or forget the saved one.
When AVAILABLE	Icon shown next to "AVAILABLE". Can be (none).
When IN MEETING	Icon shown next to "IN MEETING". Can be (none).
When AWAY	Icon shown next to "AWAY" when the computer is locked. Can be (none).
Polling interval (s)	How often the program checks the mic/camera (default 5 seconds). Lock/unlock is instant and does not depend on this.

Icons

The icons are drawn as clean single-color symbols that suit e-paper. You freely choose which one is shown for each status – or none at all.

Icons for **AVAILABLE**:



Check



Thumb



Coffee



Circle



Smiley

Icons for **IN MEETING**:



Speech



Camera



Headset



Phone



Video

Icons for **AWAY**:



Lock



Door



Clock



Moon



Walk



Coffee

5. The system tray menu

Right-click the program icon in the Windows system tray to reach the menu.

Status	Current mode: AVAILABLE, IN MEETING, AWAY or OFF.
Source	What triggered the status (e.g. Teams.exe, or “locked”).
Tag	The tag's state: ready, writing... or off.
Settings...	Opens the settings window.
Update tag now	Forces an immediate redraw of the tag.
Setup help	Opens the built-in help text.
Quit	Exits the program.

Away when you lock the computer

When you lock Windows – by pressing **Win+L**, or any other way the screen locks – the program switches to **AWAY** immediately and writes that to the tag. The moment you unlock and sign back in, it returns to **AVAILABLE**, or to **IN MEETING** if a call is still using your microphone or camera.

Lock and unlock are detected instantly through Windows session events, so they do not wait for the polling interval. While you are locked the program leaves the tag on **AWAY** and does not check the mic or camera.

If **AWAY** never appears, open **meeting_status.log** next to the program and look for the line “Session monitor active (instant lock/unlock).” at startup, and “WTS_SESSION_LOCK received” when you press Win+L. Their absence points to the session listener failing to register.

About mute

When you click “mute” in Teams or similar, the microphone is still kept open at the system level – the app just stops sending audio. The program therefore shows you as **IN MEETING** even while muted. The only mode that is not detected is when you are muted, the camera is off, and you are only listening.

6. Troubleshooting

The tag does not update

- Check that the tag is awake and within range (~10 m).
- Make sure the correct address is saved in the settings.
- Look in the log file **meeting_status.log** next to the program.

The scan finds no tags

- Tags only advertise for a short while after waking – remove and reinsert a battery, then scan immediately.
- Check that Bluetooth is turned on in Windows.
- Some desktop PCs have no Bluetooth – use a USB dongle or a laptop.

AWAY does not appear when I lock the computer

- Open **meeting_status.log** and confirm the session monitor registered at startup. If you see “Session monitor failed”, the listener could not register – restart the program.
- In some locked-down corporate environments, session-change notifications can be restricted by group policy.

AWAY stays on after I unlock

- This version only changes the lock state from Win+L lock/unlock events, so it should clear instantly. If it does not, check the log for an “WTS_SESSION_UNLOCK received” entry.

The text on the tag looks wrong (rotated, mirrored or wrong color)

- Adjust the PANEL constants at the top of the script: **PANEL_ROTATION**, **PANEL_INVERT_BW** and **PANEL_INVERT_RED**.

Windows Defender or antivirus flags the .exe

- This is a common false positive for PyInstaller-built programs. Approve the file manually if you trust it.

Tag model: Gicisky / PICKSMART 2.9" e-paper, 296×128 pixels, black/white/red, Bluetooth Low Energy.

Purchased from: AliExpress – “2.9” E Ink Screen Price Tag”.

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Windows only. Use at your own risk.